

Elevance Payer Policy: Total Knee Arthroplasty

CPT/HCPCS Code: 27447 | Version: 2026-Q3 | Effective Date: 2026-07-01

Specialty Requirement

This service requires a referral from: Orthopedic Surgery referral.

Required Supporting Documentation

1. Radiology Report
2. Clinical Assessment Notes
3. Conservative Therapy Logs
4. Orthopedic Surgery Referral Letter
5. Primary Care Physician Letter

Clinical Prerequisites

1. Diagnosis of advanced osteoarthritis (ICD-10 M17.11)
2. Radiology report confirming Kellgren-Lawrence Grade 3 or 4 joint space narrowing
3. Standardized joint pain assessment score (e.g. WOMAC or KOOS) confirming severe functional limitation
4. Trial of conservative non-surgical management for at least 12 weeks

Notes

Requests lacking any of the required supporting documentation above will be returned to the provider for additional evidence unless the case includes clearly documented exigent circumstances warranting expedited review.